

5.4

Topics for letters, faxes and e-mails

Worksheet

Choose one of these topics. Adapt the topic to make it similar to documents you write in your own real-life job. Then:

- A** Write a business letter or fax (you decide which). Some topics have two letters/faxes.
- B** Write exactly the same document/s as an e-mail (shorter and more direct).

- 1
 - a) Write a letter/fax from a potential new customer to your company requesting information about some products you sell.
 - b) Write a letter/fax in reply: thank them, provide further information about the specific products, suggest action for them to take.
- 2
 - a) Write a letter/fax from a real-life customer/supplier abroad to you, asking to visit your company.
 - b) Then write a letter/fax from yourself in reply: give details of the visit and say how much you are looking forward to seeing him/her.
- 3 Write a letter/fax from you to a hotel abroad to enquire about accommodation. Say where you found their name, mention rooms and dates and any specific requirements.
- 4
 - a) Write a letter/fax from you to one of your real-life suppliers complaining about a typical problem that often occurs.
 - b) Then write a letter/fax from the supplier in reply: apologize, explain and promise action.
- 5
 - a) Write a letter/fax from a real-life customer to your company complaining about a typical problem that can occur in your business.
 - b) Then write a letter/fax from your company in reply: apologize, explain and promise action.
- 6 Write a letter/fax from you to a real-life customer telling them that the goods they require are no longer available. Offer an alternative.
- 7
 - a) Write a letter/fax from you to a real-life customer requesting payment of an unpaid invoice.
 - b) Then imagine that you had received a similar letter from one of your suppliers and write a reply.
- 8 Write a letter/fax thanking somebody from another company for their time or help.
- 9 Write a letter/fax to a real-life colleague/customer/supplier telling them about a change in your plans. Give a reason and suggest/describe an alternative.
- 10 Imagine that you saw an advert for a job in a real-life company where you would like to work. Write a letter of application: mention the post and the advertisement, mention why you are applying, briefly discuss your work experience and say you are enclosing your CV.

